Mini Assessment

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1. If an API returns 429, what should your program do?

Answer: A 429 error means “Too Many Requests”, which happens when the API is called too many times in a short period. The program should wait for some time before trying again. If a Retry-After value is provided, it should follow that time. Otherwise, it can use increasing delays between retries. After a limited number of attempts, it should stop and handle the error properly instead of retrying continuously.

2. If response.json() fails, what should your program do?

Answer: response.json() may fail if the response is empty, invalid, or not in JSON format. The program should handle this using try-except instead of crashing. It should check the response status and, if necessary, read the response as text to understand the error. The error can also be logged for debugging.

3. If a JSON key is missing, why might .get() be safer than []?

Answer: Using data['key'] gives a KeyError if the key does not exist. But data.get('key') safely returns None instead of stopping the program. We can also provide a default value, such as data.get('key', 'default_value'). Therefore, .get() makes the program more reliable when working with uncertain JSON data.